

piers. The one over the River Kolab is a good example where a long steel-work weighing 1,315 tonnes had to be assembled and set over piers as deep as 26.8 m.



▲ **The large-scale, open cast iron ore mines** of Bailadila are among the first of its kind in India. They have the unique distinction of having a down-the-hill convoy system that passes through a tunnel to move the iron ore from a crushing plant to the processing plant.

At great cost

The entire K–K line cost Rs 553 million and was built manually with the help of 30,000 labourers. In fact, the only mechanical equipment used was an air compressor. It took about four and a half years to complete the construction and the line opened for freight traffic in May 1966. The movement of iron ore finally began the following year in May 1967.

Today, the K–K line is celebrated for its breathtaking views as it passes through the Borra Guhalu station, named after the prehistoric caves below it, and the Araku Valley in the Visakhapatnam district of Andhra Pradesh, home to many rare and endangered birds and plants.